

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 410

Culture (OWC): [Konso \(MP17\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1965-1967, 1997

Coverage Date: 1965 AD - 1967 AD

Place Coverage

Gaho, Konso Special Woreda, Southern Nations, Nationalities, and Peoples' Region, Ethiopia

Section Title(S): 5. The Suaita Qondina

This was the most dramatic instance of possession I ever witnessed in Qondina's house. On some evenings when I went, however, the *ayanna* never came at all, either because there was too much joking, or because Qondina was not feeling well enough.

123
[Observation In Research](#)

774
[Animism](#)

787
[Revelation And Divination](#)

Every Sunday she would begin beating her drum, often before six in the morning, and would become possessed almost immediately. But on these occasions I think the possession was simulated, for instead of its lasting only half an hour to an hour she would speak in the deep hoarse tones which signified possession for as much as ten hours at a time. Her possession on Saturday evenings was marked by an apparent ignorance of what was going on around her, and it seemed that the trance needed to be sustained by violent physical activity; but on Sundays she had to answer questions about difficult personal problems, and as well as doing this to her clients' apparent satisfaction, she showed an acute awareness of what was going on in the main part of the hut (on Sundays she sat behind her partition). She was also unable to sustain her trance on these occasions by dancing. While the spirit was supposed only to know [411](#) Orominya, she spoke to me in Konsinya, as she knew that I had no Orominya. For all these reasons I think that her trance on Sundays was simulated, whereas her behaviour on Saturday nights was an example of an abnormal mental state.

158
[Personality Disorders](#)

774
[Animism](#)

782
[Prayers And Sacrifices](#)

787
[Revelation And Divination](#)

794
[Congregations](#)

*755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511*

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)